Jimmy Lee 李兆康

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Fellow in Economics Sept 2024 – Present
Global Poverty Research Lab, Northwestern University

Visiting Scholar Jan 2025 – June 2026
Center for International Development, Harvard University

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Northwestern University 2024
M.Phil., Economics, The Chinese University of Hong Kong 2017
B.SSc., Economics, The Chinese University of Hong Kong 2015

RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics, Program Evaluation
Family Economics, Organizational Economics
Behavioral Economics

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, Northwestern University
Introduction to Microeconomics, Introduction to Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, International Trade, Economics of Nonprofit Organizations

Teaching Assistant, The Chinese University of Hong Kong
Mathematical Methods in Economics I, II, Family Economics, Labor Economics, International Macroeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Miscategorization as an Information Friction? Activating School-Based Agricultural Education in Liberia with Parental Engagement"
(Funded by AFD Fund for Innovation in Development, USAID-DIV, Wellspring Foundation, and FAO)

WORKING PAPERS

1. **"Technology Adoption and Schooling as Complements: The Promise of School-Based Agricultural Education in Africa"** (joint with Christopher Udry)
2. **"Endogenous Model Uncertainty and Curiosity under Cognitive Limits"**
3. **"Can Communicating Parents' Beliefs to Students Be a Pivotal Component of Parental Engagement? Evidence from School-Based Agricultural Education in Liberia"**
   (Funded by NSF, Weiss Fund, Global Poverty Research Lab, and the Buffett Institute for Global Affairs)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Ongoing Randomized Experiments (scaling SBAE across Liberia, Côte d'Ivoire, and Kenya in 2026-35)

1. **"Learning to Learn: Synergizing Inquiry-based Science and Agricultural Transformation in Liberia"** (joint with Vesall Nourani, Harvard GSE; scheduled RCT within the scaling of SBAE in 2026-29)
2. **"Parental Engagement in School-based Agricultural Education: Testing Mechanisms at Scale"** (piloted interventions in 2025-26)
3. **"School-based Agricultural Education, Parental Engagement, and the Use of Unconditional Cash Transfers"**
4. **"Directed Technical Change under Data-Driven Farming Advice: An Empirical Framework"** (grant from Weiss Fund; piloted survey method; planning RCT)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Total program evaluation and academic research grants secured for SBAE in Liberia: **$4.2 million**

Program Evaluation Grants

AFD Fund for Innovation in Development ($1.2 mil; co-PI) 2025
J-PAL Learning for All Initiative: Scaling Award ($222K; co-PI) 2024
USAID Development Innovation Ventures ($395K; co-PI) 2022

Wellspring Foundation ($192K; co-PI) 2022
AFD Fund for Innovation in Development ($1.2 mil; co-PI) 2021
Food and Agriculture Organization ($68K; co-PI) 2021

Academic Research Awards

J-PAL Learning for All Initiative ($400K; co-PI) 2025
Weiss Fund ($5K; Lead PI) 2022
National Science Foundation ($451K; co-PI) 2020
Weiss Fund ($29K; Lead PI) 2020
Global Poverty Research Lab ($19K; Lead PI) 2019
Buffett Institute for Global Affairs ($5K; Lead PI) 2019

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

During postdoctoral studies:

Mundlak Workshop in Agricultural and Applied Economics (scheduled); National Chung Cheng University; NYU Africa House–Center for Technology, Economics, and Development (CTED); Mohammed VI Polytechnic University (UM6P); Tel Aviv University; Oklahoma State University; Harvard Center for International Development; Africa Food Systems Forum 2024

During PhD:

Meeting of the Society of Economics of the Household (SEHO); J-PAL—Middle East and North Africa (MENA); CGIAR—Standing Panel on Impact Assessment (SPIA); International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI); University of Glasgow; National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies (GRIPS, Tokyo); Development Day 2023

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Citizenship: Hong Kong Special Administrative Region, China
Languages: English (fluent), French (intermediate), Mandarin (fluent), Cantonese (native)
Programming: Stata, R, Matlab, Python, ArcGIS, SurveyCTO

REFERENCES

Professor Christopher Udry (Chair)
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